

Pocketful of Insights

Decoding longevity,
ageing, and
peri/menopause

making simple for HUL
june of 2026

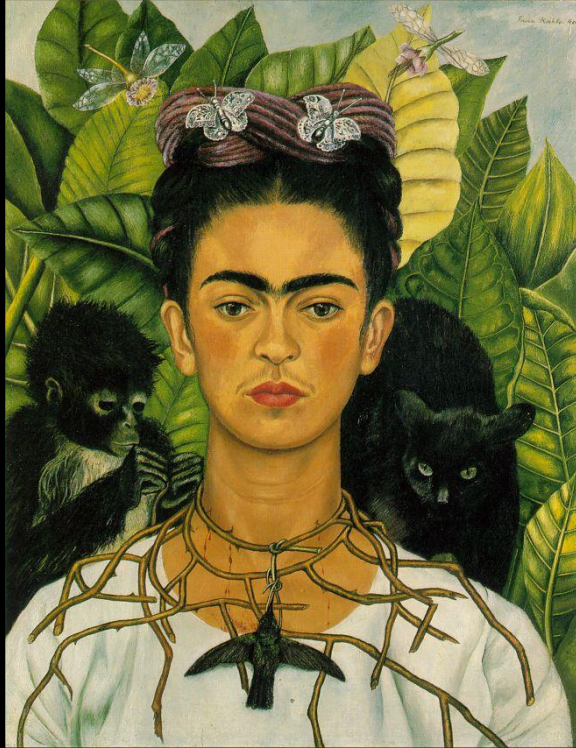


Girl Before a Mirror
by Pablo Picasso
Oil on canvas, in 1932

Denotes female relevant insights

Denotes male relevant insights

reporting & analysis for females

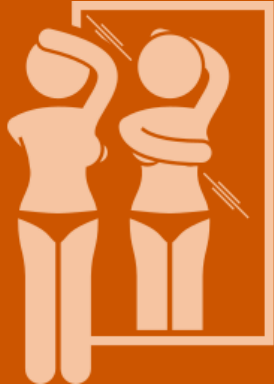


Self-portrait With Necklace Of
Thorns

Frida Kahlo, in 1940
Oil on Canvas



Ageing is triggered by visibility, realised through instability



HAIR

- Hair loss, thinning, greying
- Thick facial hair growth

SKIN

- Dull skin and pigmentation
- Skin sagging cheeks and breasts
- Dark circles, fine lines and crow's feet
- Freckles
- Puffiness and swollen face

BODY SHAPE

- Stubborn belly fat
- Drooping posture
- Broadening of hips

Visible signs = wake up calls



HORMONAL & INTERNAL

- Delayed, skipped cycles
- Sudden fatigue and discomfort compromising daily functioning
- Emotional turmoil and mood swings
- Overthinking, short temper, sudden irritability,
- Brain fog and forgetfulness
- Unexplained night sweats, palpitations, hot flashes
- Reduced tolerance for daily demands

Internal shifts = alarm bells

Locked in a continuous tug-of-war with their visible bodily changes as they cycle through a fragmented coping spectrum

Dealing with visible signs

FIX: hair loss, greying, weight gain, belly fat, wrinkles, skin dullness & pigmentation

FORFEIT: hair loss, greying, weight gain, belly fat, wrinkles, skin dullness & pigmentation

FRET: hair loss, greying, weight gain, belly fat, wrinkles, skin dullness & pigmentation

FORGIVE: sagging breasts, fine lines, grey hairs (for some women)

How females cope?

FIX: Putting in the effort to be "presentable" makes them believe they can still fix this and are still in control

FORFEIT: Waving the white flag and abandoning unwinnable battles as constant fixing and fretting can lead to exhaustion

FRET: Feel betrayed and unable to trust their body which threatens self-esteem and confidence

FORGIVE: Viewing them as a universal natural progression they need to live with

*For example: A woman will **Fret** over her first white hairs, aggressively **Fix** them with dye to maintain social standing and confidence, eventually **Forfeit** the exhausting salon trips, and finally **Forgive** them, viewing her "salt and pepper" look as a natural progression*

Females move from normalising early internal signs to confronting change and ultimately enduring a new physical reality

Normalising (35–40)

MINDSET: Symptoms are dismissed as lifestyle stress; belief that the body will recover on its own

RESPONSE: Following overall best practice preventive measures and minimal interventions believing body will bounce back

Confronting Tipping point (41–45)

MINDSET: Body feels unpredictable and out of control, triggering panic and confusion

RESPONSE: Frantic experimentation and reactive “fixing” to regain normalcy requiring more adjustments and interventions

Enduring (46–50)

MINDSET: Acceptance that change is ongoing and cannot be reversed, only managed

RESPONSE: Shift to adaptation by simplifying routines, setting boundaries, and sustaining daily functioning through selective routine commitment

Solutions must support women through the disruption phase of perimenopause, not just overall prevention helping them navigate chaos and rebuild control, beyond maintaining health in the long run

While the known destination is menopause, the turbulent journey of perimenopause is a “black box” that leaves women feeling helpless

Symptoms start as “grey areas” (fatigue, weight gain, sleep issues) and are initially dismissed as reactions to stress before clearer hormonal signals emerge



Uncertainty pushes females to an urgent “meaning-making” phase to try to regain control, decode symptoms, connect patterns and find explanations

Perimenopause is not guided; it is navigated through confusion, peer communities and continuous experimentation of solutions to help them cope

Telltale signs to link symptoms with perimenopause: mood swings, hot flashes, menstrual cycle disruptions and low sexual libido

The Wake Up Call – when mind and body demands active, deliberate effort just to feel "normal" again

Moments when ageing is FELT and can no longer be blamed on everyday stress and external factors

Betrayal of the Menstrual Cycle

- Delayed, skipped or closely spaced cycles create anxiety and signal loss of bodily control
- Shift from predictability to uncertainty makes ageing feel immediate and undeniable
- This **hormonal shift** forces females out of denial

Body Thermostat Breakdown

- Unexplained night sweats, palpitations and hot flashes despite normal/cold temperatures triggers confusion and uneasiness

Sudden Toll of Everyday Routines

- Activities once effortless now lead to aches and pains, fatigue or discomfort

Brain fog

- Forgetfulness in simple, everyday tasks disrupts confidence
- Moments of mental blankness create a sense of disorientation

Emotional hijacking

- Sudden irritability, overthinking, short temper and mood swings are difficult to regulate
- Reduced tolerance for daily demands leads to withdrawal or the need for personal space

Women mask the internal struggles during perimenopause, amplifying their isolation and self-doubt

Visible coping (above the surface)

- Sleep disruption at night tackled by need for more rest periods during the day
- Trying her best to maintain work, social, fitness and household roles while suppressing her internal struggles and normalising symptoms as stress
- Emotional swings - Loses temper and uncharacteristic irritability
- Trying to make sense of symptoms and experimenting with targeted fixes
- Faking sexual intimacy with partners
- Black circles, weight gain, sweat marks trigger self-consciousness

Invisible breakdown (beneath the surface)

- Unpredictability and inability to bounce back from a bad day
- Chronic fatigue and collapse of multitasking
- Troubled by night sweats, hot flashes
- Emotional hijacking - sudden temper and irritability followed by post outburst guilt
- Overthinking and brain fog
- Feels alone and disconnected, unable to make sense of changes when the world around her mistakes perimenopausal symptoms for "attitude problem"
- Burnout because of faking normalcy on the outside
- Crashed libido
- Pill fatigue
- Personality disruption and lowered confidence

Losing control of my personality

Loss of trust in my own mind and body

Disruptive shifts– Internal shifts that completely paralyse their day to day functioning are those that hamper productivity and social equation

EMOTIONAL OUTBURSTS

"I feel so irritated and angry with my husband and my son at times, they say they have to talk to me according to my mood...later I feel so guilty and think why did I overreact?!"
F/41-45/MUM

SUDDEN SURPRISES

"Whether if it is a guest who comes unannounced, an abrupt change of plan or routine or if it is an early period it is so difficult to switch my mindset, to cope and to be prepared" F/46-50/BLR

INABILITY TO MULTITASK

"Earlier I used to handle so many things at once now because of this unease, this mental pressure sometimes I'll sit alone, sometimes I'll be just lost, it takes 2-3 minutes to realise what I'm thinking and what I'm doing it."
F/41-45/MYS

SLEEP DEPRIVATION

"If I don't take proper sleep...wake up in the middle of the night because I am feeling hot my next 24 hours are completely spoiled, everything gets messed up"
F/35-40/DEL

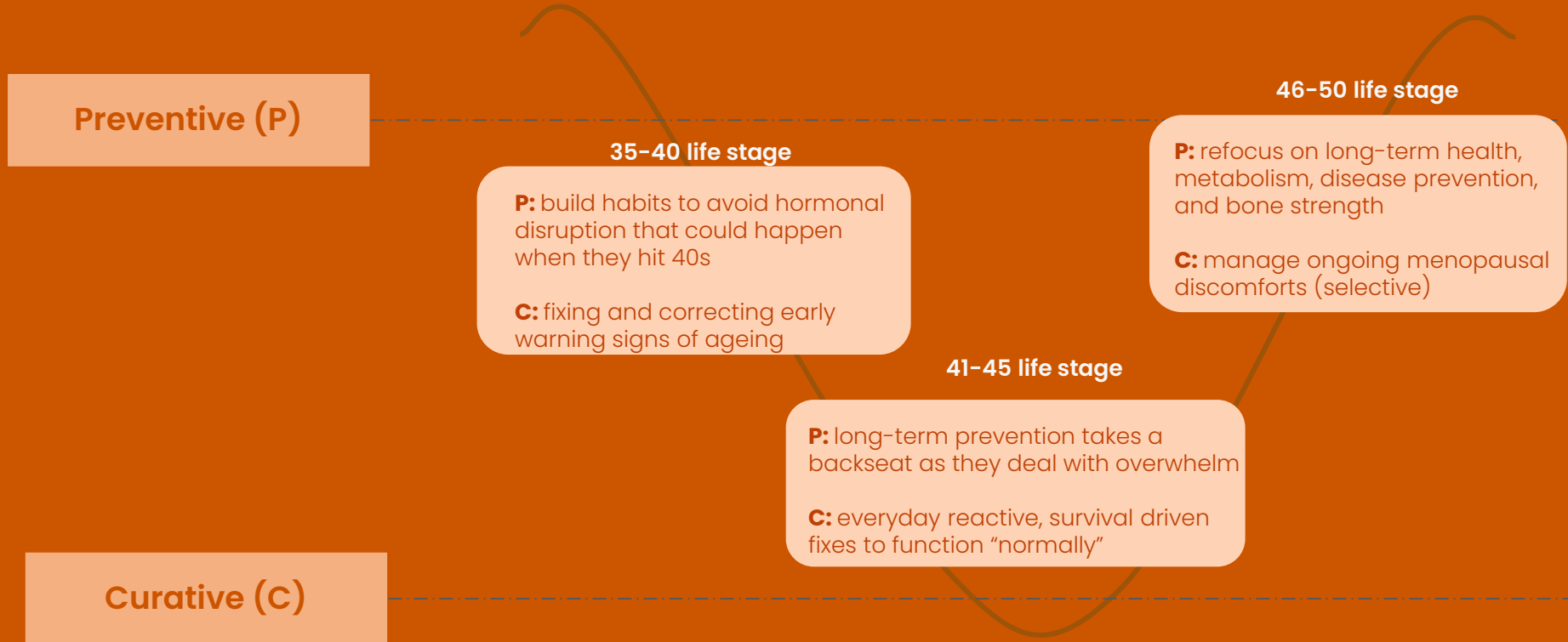
UNABLE TO BOUNCE BACK

"Recovering from a bruise or even an emotional day clearly very different from say 5 years ago and poor night of sleep makes it worse!" F/35-40/GOA

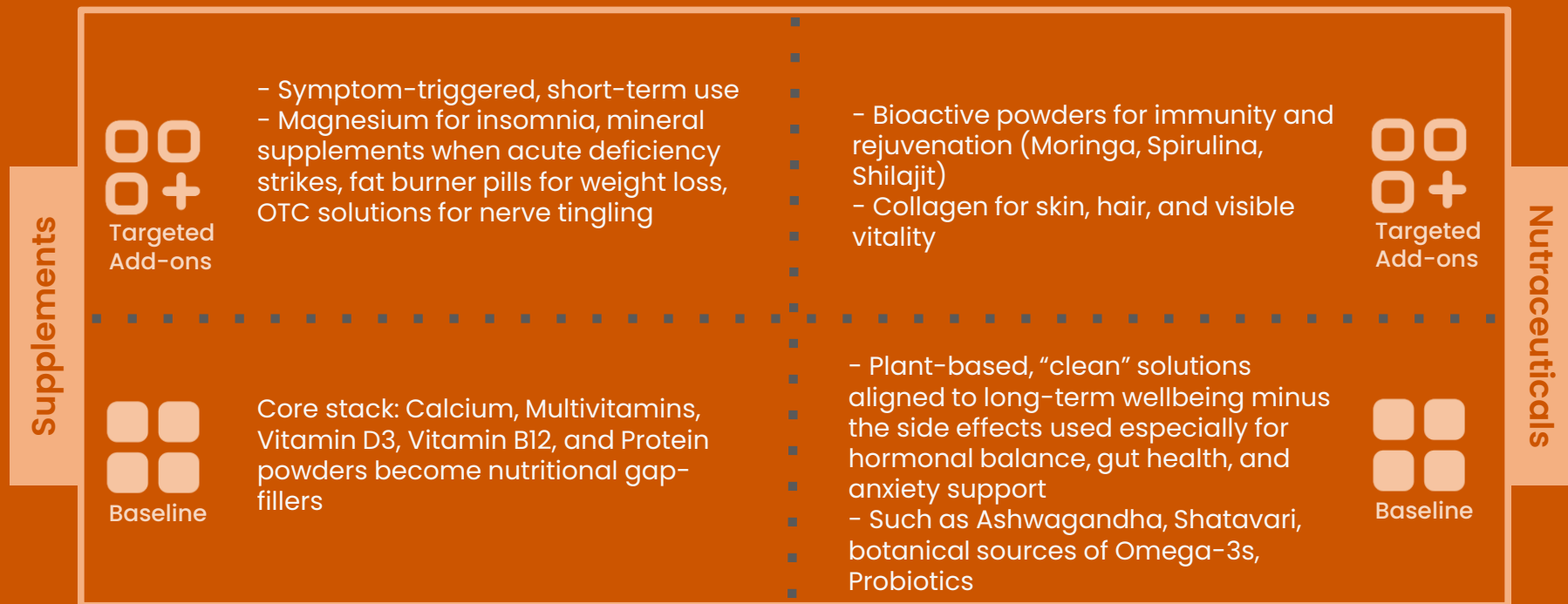
FATIGUE

"There are some mornings when I feel like I just can't go ahead with the day, I feel exhausted my mind plays games and unfortunately this happens on Sunday, my family is calling it the 'Sunday dosh' now" F/46-50/MYS

Ageing journey is non-linear where preventive intent and action collapses during perimenopausal chaos before being gradually rebuilt to restore control



Health is no longer solely diet-led, women actively construct hybrid wellness systems combining science and nature to stay functional and in control



Gravitate toward nutraceuticals for hormonal balance despite limited awareness of their classification or terminology

Adoption is driven by effectiveness, ease and trust, while anything complex, artificial or unrewarding is dropped (1/2)



What Sticks (Sustained Behaviours)

- Commit to solutions that offer noticeable results and easy to integrate
- Provides fundamental stability without severe side effects
- Heavy dependence on baseline supplements and change up flavours when bored of taste

Baseline & "SOS" Supplement Mix: protein (whey/plant), multivitamins, Calcium, Vit D & B, magnesium for sleep, Omega-3

Home remedies: (flax, pumpkin, almonds), methi (fenugreek) water, jeera water, and traditional hair oiling

Ayurvedic support: Ashwagandha, Moringa, plant-based Vitamin C

Diet control: portion regulation, restriction of junk food/sugar/processed items, avoid bloating and acidity

Movement: brisk walking, yoga, stretching, weight training

AM/PM Skincare: sunscreens, moisturisers, and active serums to conceal/fix skin issues

Behaviour	Brands / Products
Daily supplements (non-negotiables)	ProteinX, The Whole Truth, Centrum, Shelcal, HK Vitals, OZiva
Targeted bioactives for hormones, weight, stress	OZiva Biotin, Plix Glow, Earthful, Bodywise, Amway Nutrilite, Forever Living
Ayurvedic and plant-based support	Ashwagandha, Shatavari, Moringa, Omega-3, Apple Cider Vinegar, Collagen, Spirulina
Skincare and haircare	L'Oreal, Minimalist, Ponds, Lakme, Olay, Dove, Dermaco

Adoption is driven by effectiveness, ease and trust, while anything complex, artificial or unrewarding is dropped (2/2)



What Drops (Abandoned / Avoided Behaviours)

-Supplement fatigue is real, females drop supplements in case no noticeable payoff within a month

- Avoid supplements with unpleasant taste, artificially sweetened

Invasive Clinical and Cosmetic Procedures: low trust, unnatural, meant only for "film stars," (scary news stories of celebrity deaths due to I.V. drips)

Fad Diets & supplements: hard to sustain strict diets alongside family meals. drop supplements with no noticeable benefits

Heavy medical interventions: avoid treatments like HRT, doctor prescribed hormonal correction pills, sleeping pills deemed ""messing with things" artificially

Unpalatable Formats: chemical or artificial sugary tasting formats seem unnatural and off putting

Behaviour	Brands / Products
Caused adverse reactions	Herbalife Skin Booster (triggered acne, disrupted cycles)
Unpalatable formats abandoned	Fast&Up gut health shots (bad taste, artificial sweeteners)
Heavy clinical interventions avoided	HRT, doctor prescribed hormonal pills, sleeping pills
Invasive cosmetic procedures avoided	IV drips, medicated facials (fear of side effects, "for film stars only")
Supplements with no visible payoff	Brands switched or dropped if no results within one month
Artificial or chemical formats rejected	Artificially sweetened supplements, chemical-tasting formats

Over the years “Feel” anchors “Look”, defined by achieving internal harmony and self-reliance, while the pursuit of superficial youthfulness is gradually let go

LOOK of ageing

35-40 years

Turning back the clock ->

41-45 years

Trying to stop the clock ->

46-50 years

Letting go and running with the clock

Ageing well **visually** is defined not by erasing signs of age, but by embracing them with authenticity, inner vitality and confident, dignified self-projection.

FEEL of ageing

35-40 years

Carried by the current ->

41-45 years

Pushing against the current ->

46-50 years

Learning to flow with the new me

Ageing well **internally** is defined by self-reliance, emotional maturity and consciously managed energy; where women regain control, set boundaries for self-preservation and rebuild confidence self-trust.

What does “ageing well” look like? (female verbatims)

“I want to look younger than my age... I have to do so many efforts taking... more time spend more time on myself so that I can shine and bright.” F/35-40/CHD

“I don't want to look like I am 35. My students tell me I look 26-27 years, I also get proposals from 20 year old males...so this is my motivation to take efforts and care for my skin and stay in shape” F/35-40/MUM

“Somebody who's like Zeenat Aman, who's like, you know, Neetu Kapoor, we've got Neena Gupta and all, they're ageing so beautifully... People know that you're ageing but they respect you because you're ageing gracefully and well-being physically also, mentally also” F/35-40/BLR

“I want to get back to shape for sure which I've been wishing since 8 years. Want to fit into my old clothes.” F/35-40/MUM

“Because if you're mentally stable, if you're mentally strong and you're mentally contended, that glow reflects on your face. Let's say if you're taking some stress... it definitely shows on your face” F/46-50/BLR

“Sameera Reddy takes her age very gracefully. She is so honest about how she appears, never covers her white hairs... She has so many scars on her face. She is taking very positively everything, I am inspired by her” F/35-40/DEL

Ageing well for women is anchored in three pillars: self-reliance, inner purpose, and sustained vitality that enable independence, meaning, and long-term wellbeing

Self-reliance

- Aspire to retain the willpower, bodily strength and financial independence
- Maintaining mobility and the ability to live without becoming a burden



Maturity and purpose

- Actively guarding mental boundaries (protecting “Me time”)
- Shifting from caregiving roles to self-driven purpose to lead by example for their children
- Embracing ageing with dignity, confidence, and acceptance without giving in to societal expectations



Sustained vitality and energy

- Managing energy, fitness, and metabolic health as essential resources
- Prioritising long-term physical resilience over short-term appearance
- Define longevity not by how long they live, but by how durable, active, and sustainable their health remains



How ageing is negotiated when looking into the mirror?

FROM **CURRENT SELF**

Handling everything life throws at me,
while still trying to look put together

Keeping changes in appearances under
control

Holding back indulgences to protect
how I look

Seeing life's chaos show up in my
appearance

TO **DESIRED SELF**

Looking vibrant and visibly confident
without the strain

Feeling effortless in your own skin

Enjoying life without restraint or worrying
about how it shows on me

Wanting to look steady, balanced and in
control

Women reject medicalisation, turning instead to peer-led and self-guided/ self-diagnosed support systems



“I am not a patient” mindset

- Perimenopausal symptoms are not viewed as a “disease” leading women to avoid medical consultation unless symptoms become severe or unmanageable
- Women without periodic engagement with a gynecologist may seek medical consultation closer to menopause for clarity, diagnosis, and if there are serious concerns



Emotional validation

JTBD: Help me understand what my body is going through so I don't feel confused, alone, or dismissed

No product fixes this. Women described their hormonal shifts being dismissed as an "attitude problem" by the people closest to them. Ekta said it directly: "I have hit a physical and emotional wall. I am not this person."

OZiva / Comms

Campaign: Run a campaign separate from product marketing that names the lived experience: post-outburst guilt, faking intimacy, exhaustion of keeping the house running while falling apart. No product shot. OZiva logo at the end.

Purpose: This campaign earns the trust that makes HerBalance considered. Without it, HerBalance is just another SKU women scroll past

Talent: Replace Deepika Padukone for this campaign with a voice like Sameera Reddy, someone who has spoken openly about this phase. Aspiration does not land here. Relatability does

New brand/product consideration

What: A standalone community platform for perimenopausal women, separate from OZiva — peer support, monthly gynaecologist Q&A, and a symptom tracker that tells women where they are in the journey

Why: Intimacy, shame, and symptoms women cannot discuss with their husbands are outside the territory a supplement brand can own. This needs a different vehicle

Evaluate: HUL may want to assess whether this white space is large enough to justify a new brand built around guidance and community, with OZiva product recommendations as a natural monetisation path



Decode the “black box” of perimenopause/ menopause

JTBD: Help me make sense of my symptoms and know what to do at each stage, without feeling overwhelmed; **an app or a WhatsApp Saheli** would do the job

Women are confused and self-diagnosing when peak hormonal changes strike in their 40s. No brand in India has built a credible symptom to solution journey for this cohort.

OZiva / Product + utility

Navigator: Build a WhatsApp based perimenopause symptom navigator under the OZiva brand — five questions, stage output, recommended OZiva stack. No app download required

Sequencing: Launch the navigator before the product campaign, not alongside it. Trust in the tool earns the product consideration. Not the other way around

Asset: This builds a direct data relationship with perimenopausal women that HUL does not currently have and no competitor can replicate quickly

Olly / Product entry

Product: “Balanced Perimeno” exists in the US and is clinically studied for perimenopause. No Indian brand has this credential

Gap: The name is too clinical for a brand whose entire appeal is friendliness and simplicity. Needs India market testing before launch

Timing: This is not a day one India launch SKU. Let Olly establish its friendly format equity first, then bring Balanced Perimeno in as a second wave product



Owning Perimenopause relief space

JTBD: Help me get reliable relief from my symptoms through solutions I can trust and stick to

Near zero unprompted awareness of any single product addressing perimenopause directly in the study. Women are willing to invest if something delivers visible results but right now nothing has earned that trust.

OZiva / Brand architecture + comms

Visibility: HerBalance for Menopause exists but is buried in the women's health catalogue. It needs its own identity, visual language, and campaign — broken out of the range and given space to be found

Channel: Seed the campaign through voices women in this study actually trust — Dr. Narayan Banerjee, Dr. Gagan Sethi, Dr. Rekha on Instagram and YouTube. Not celebrity endorsement. Expert co-creation

Objective: Make HerBalance the first product a perimenopausal woman thinks of, not the one she stumbles across after three months of searching

Olly / Hero SKU for India entry

Product: Lead India entry with "Mellow Menopause" not Sleep or Goodbye Stress. It is the one product no Indian competitor can match on clinical credentials: studied for 11 symptoms including hot flashes, vaginal dryness, and mood swings

Positioning: Clinical credibility in a non-clinical format. That combination does not exist in India yet

Name: "Mellow" may not travel in the Indian market. Localisation testing needed before launch



Tailored and personalised solutions

JTBD: Help me find solutions that are right for my body and life stage, without trial and error

Women are not looking for generic supplements. The Vata/Pitta/Kapha framework came up organically in the study – not prompted – which signals how deeply this personalisation instinct runs.

OZiva only / Product + platform

Profiling: Build a *dosha* based profiling layer into the OZiva purchase journey – five questions online or in store, output is your body type plus your recommended OZiva stack. No new products needed, just a smarter way into the existing range

Life stage stacking: Layer age band on top of dosha profile to create a "your OZiva system" output – body type plus life stage equals your combination. This makes the range feel made for you, not made for everyone

Competitive moat: No other supplement brand in India can build this combination of Ayurvedic personalisation and life stage logic credibly. This is OZiva's territory alone



Plant based solutions for hormonal imbalance

JTBD: Help me manage my hormonal changes with safe, natural solutions I feel comfortable using daily

Women in the study are already combining Ashwagandha, Shatavari, and Omega 3 from multiple unbranded sources. They are self-assembling the solution OZiva already has. The gap is awareness and navigation, not product.

OZiva only / Comms + bundling

Bundle: Launch a curated hormonal harmony bundle for the 41 to 45 perimenopause peak phase – Ashwagandha, Shatavari, and Omega 3 as one purchase, one system. Reduces choice anxiety and makes the range feel intentional rather than scattered

Comms: Shift from ingredient led to outcome led language. Not "contains Shatavari" but language that speaks to the days the body feels like it is working against you

Awareness: Women do not know OZiva has all of this. The campaign job is simply to show them the system they have been building on their own already exists, in one place



Innovative low effort formats

JTBD: Help me take care of my health in ways that are easy, enjoyable, and fit into my daily routine

"Too much of tablet I don't like. Why too many supplements? Because it will be confusing for the people."

Women want one thing that does most of the work. Pill fatigue is causing dropout before products get a chance.

OZiva / Product innovation

Gap: OZiva's range runs heavily on powders and capsules. The format itself is the barrier, not the product

Launch: A single dissolvable daily sachet combining Ashwagandha, Magnesium, Shatavari, and Vitamin D, designed to go into morning chai. One sachet, one ritual, done

Positioning: Do not market this as a supplement. Market it as a morning ritual. The format is the story

Olly / Format advantage

Launch SKUs: Sleep and Goodbye Stress as the two lead products for women 38 to 50

Message: The entire campaign brief is that this does not feel like medicine. No ingredient education needed

Advantage: Gummies are structurally what Indian women describe when they say they do not want pills. The format removes the barrier before the product even needs to prove itself



Shifting to inside out healing mindset

JTBD: Help me improve how I feel from within so I can feel balanced, energetic, and in control

Two distinct consumer states sit inside this white space:

Reactive: women currently dealing with sleep disruption, gut issues, hormonal stress, and flagging stamina.

Preventive: women building bone health, vitality, and metabolic resilience for the long term. Same woman, different moments in her journey.

OZiva / Portfolio architecture

Structure: Create two clearly labelled entry points within the OZiva women's range. "Right Now" for the reactive cluster covering sleep, gut, hormonal stress, and stamina. "For the Long Game" for the preventive cluster covering bone health, vitality, and metabolism

Action: This is a catalogue and comms change, not a new product brief. The products exist. Women just cannot navigate to the right one when they need it

Both online and offline: The labelling logic needs to work in modern trade shelf placement as much as it does on the OZiva website. HUL's distribution reach makes this scalable in a way no D2C brand can match

Olly / Reactive cluster only

Product: "Balanced Perimeno" exists in the US and is clinically studied for perimenopause. No Indian brand has this credential

Fit: Sleep and Goodbye Stress map directly onto the reactive needs in this white space — the woman who is struggling right now and has not yet built a supplement habit

Entry point: Position Olly as where women start when they are in reactive mode. OZiva is where they graduate to for long term preventive care

Relationship: The two brands complement rather than compete here. Olly gets her in. OZiva keeps her



From supplements to wellness systems

JTBD: Help me move beyond scattered supplements to a simple, complete system that supports my overall health

Women described a specific fear: ending up dependent on "diabetic pills, blood pressure pills, kidney pills, and liver pills." What they want is a system today that makes that future less likely.

OZiva only / Product + platform

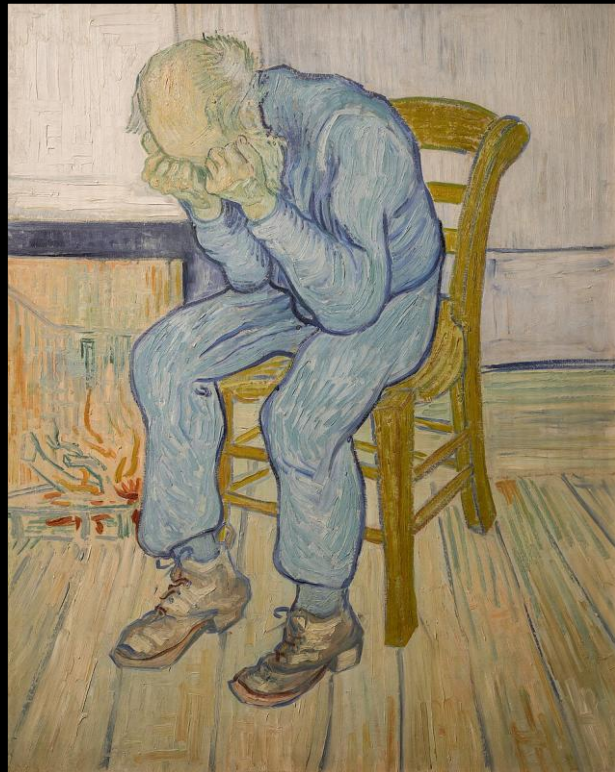
Product: Launch a life stage subscription — 35 to 40 kit, 41 to 45 kit, 46 to 50 kit — each containing the right OZiva combination for that phase. One decision, done for the month

Distribution: Make this available in modern trade, not just online. A woman picking up her monthly kit at a pharmacy or supermarket is a habit that compounds. HUL's distribution reach is the one advantage no D2C competitor can replicate

Relationship: This builds a direct ongoing relationship with women across 15 years of their health journey. That is a CRM and loyalty asset no individual product campaign can create

Oily

Oily does not fit here. The wellness system insight is about long term life stage management. Oily is not established enough in India to carry that brief.



Sorrowing Old Man (At Eternity's Gate)

Vincent van Gogh, in 1890
Oil on Canvas

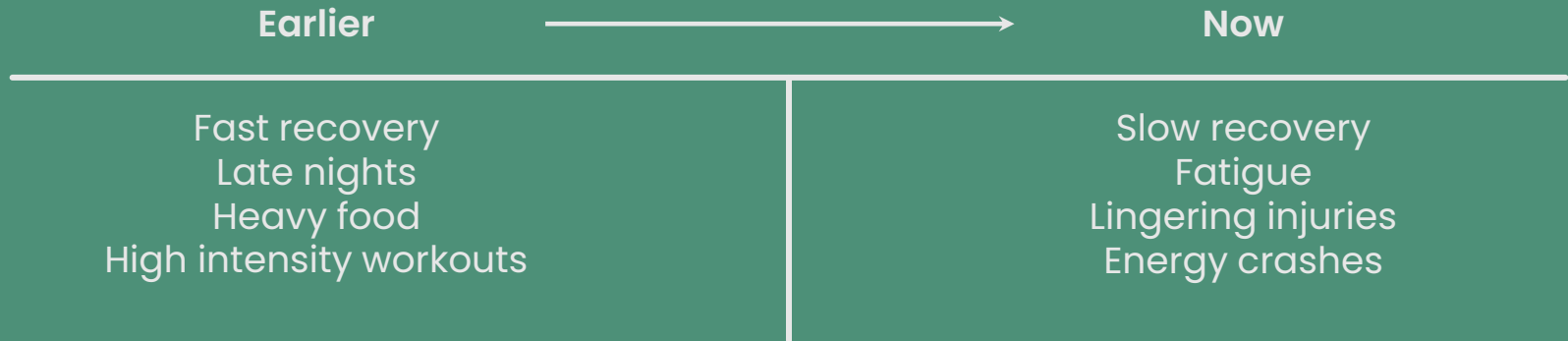


reporting & analysis for males



Body Wake-up Call: Males don't plan for longevity. They enter the space only when their body stops recovering the way it used to

1. **Slower Recovery:** Recovery slows down. Late nights, junk food or workouts take days to bounce back from.
2. **Daily Function Disruptions:** Fatigue, injuries and breathlessness disrupt daily functioning.
3. **The New Normal:** What first feels like a “bad day” slowly becomes the new normal.





Body Shape

- A major shift occurs in weight distribution: noticing sudden **weight gain and the accumulation of belly fat** or a "paunch" that causes misfit of clothes.
- Previously fit individuals notice a **loss of muscle definition**, their abs or veins are no longer visible, which leads to a "stocky" or physically depleted appearance.

- थोड़ा सा फैट एक्यूमुलेशन हुआ है

- Now I don't have abs... earlier veins were visible, now barely



Hair Changes

The most universally noted sign is **hair greying or whitening**. They frequently point out **hair thinning, significant hair fall, and receding hairlines**. Hair losing its previous shine, becoming rougher, or developing dandruff.

- मेरी शेविंग भी थोड़ी वाइट हो गई है... बाल भी वाइट हो गए हैं
- पहले शाइनिंग थे... अब रुखे और हार्ड हो गए हैं... डैंड्रफ वाली फीलिंग है



Skin Changes

Males frequently report **the loss of their youthful "glow"**, describing their facial skin as looking duller or "matured". They notice early **wrinkles around the eyes**, changes in overall skin texture, the development of double chins, and occasional pimples.

- आंखों के पास हल्के रिंकल्स आने शुरू हो गए हैं

- Earlier tight skin... now double chin

- Face getting pimples easily

"I Used to See My Veins": The sudden appearance of a paunch, dull skin, and reading glasses forces males to acknowledge they are getting older



Vision Changes

While not purely a cosmetic change, the sudden **need for reading glasses** is visibly recognised as a clear external marker that they are getting older.

- अब चश्मा लग गया है... पहले नहीं था

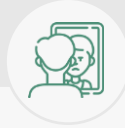
- Now reading glasses are required... earlier not there

Moments when ageing shifts from background noise to something personal and hard to ignore



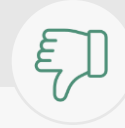
Late Nights

1. No distractions, no noise
2. Guilt and reflection surface



Post-Shower Mirror

1. Body fully visible
2. Changes feel undeniable



After a Bad Day

1. Stress and fatigue collide
2. Body feels the cost



Post-Vacation Crash

1. Sharp contrast with rest
2. Energy drop feels extreme



After Physical Strain

1. Breathlessness, slow recovery
2. Body feels older than before

Visible signs of ageing noticed first? (male verbatims)

"Face also like you see almost like a dull skin. I used to have a very nice thick skin like proper tight skin and I did not have a double chin like this."

— M/41-45/BLR

"Everybody's looking at your stomach and mostly discussing like oh you have a paunch."

— M/41-45/BLR

"One is the hair become whitened to some extent. And in my face you can see that now I have gained some weight also. Only problem is my belly which is the fat."

— M/46-50/KOL

"Feeling that dullness in the face. My hair used to be very thick. Body — muscles deplete, feeling like I'm getting weaker."

— M/41-45/CHD

"मेरी जो शेविंग होती है वो भी थोड़ी सी वाइट हो गई है और हेयर भी मेरे वाइट हो गए हैं। बाँड़ी इतनी दमदार नहीं रही जो पहले थी।"

— M/35-40/DEL

From Fixing to Preventing: Males first react to immediate health issues, but around 40 their focus shifts toward preventing long-term disease & decline.

1. **Reactive Start:** Health action begins only after symptoms like fatigue, injury or digestive issues appear.
2. **Age 40 Turning Point:** Crossing 40 creates heightened awareness of diabetes, cholesterol and lifestyle diseases.
3. **Prevention Mindset:** Supplements, routine tests and diet control become daily “insurance” against future decline.



Problem Fixing

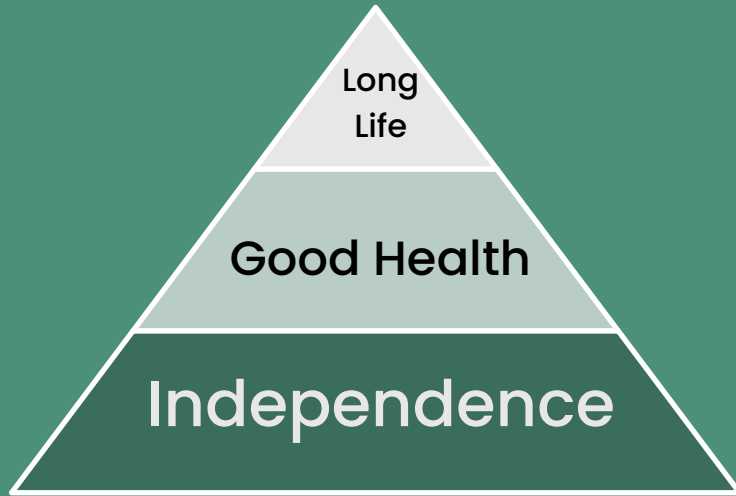


Health Awareness



Prevention

Independence Is the Real Goal: Ageing well is not about living longer. It is about staying physically capable and never becoming dependent on others.



Independence is the foundation of Ageing priorities.

1. **Self-Reliance Over Long-Life:** Living longer has little meaning if mobility and independence are lost.
2. **Fear of Dependency:** The strongest ageing anxiety is becoming physically or financially dependent on family.
3. **Capability Matters Most:** Staying able to move, travel and manage life independently becomes the core measure of ageing well.

What does “ageing well” look like? (male verbatims)

"Exercise is the best medicine. For me ageing well is I don't have to visit the doctor's office, I have ample energy to play with my kid and enjoy my life the way I want to." — M/35-40/CHD

"मैं तो चाहता था 50 साल में भी मैं वैसा देखूँ जो मैं 25 का था — वो वाली ड्रीम तो पूरी हो नहीं पाई।"
— M/35-40/DEL

"Ageing well — then you are fit and fine. You can work. You are not on bed. You are financially free. You are doing at least all the activities you want freely. You are not depending on somebody."
— M/46-50/KOL

"I want to still be able to lift my wife in my old age as well. Still make her feel like the youth days."
— M/41-45/BLR

"I don't want to be dependent on someone. I don't want to be a burden for someone else."
— M/35-40/MUM

Function Comes Before Feeling and Appearance: As males age, health priorities shift toward how the body works first, how it feels second, and how it looks last.

1. **Function First:** Mobility, stamina and physical capability become the most important indicators of ageing well.
2. **Internal Wellbeing Next:** Energy levels, digestion and sleep quality shape everyday functioning.
3. **Appearance as Outcome:** Looking younger or fitter matters, but only if the body is functioning well internally.

Decision Filter to judge wellness products or routines.



Function
benefit

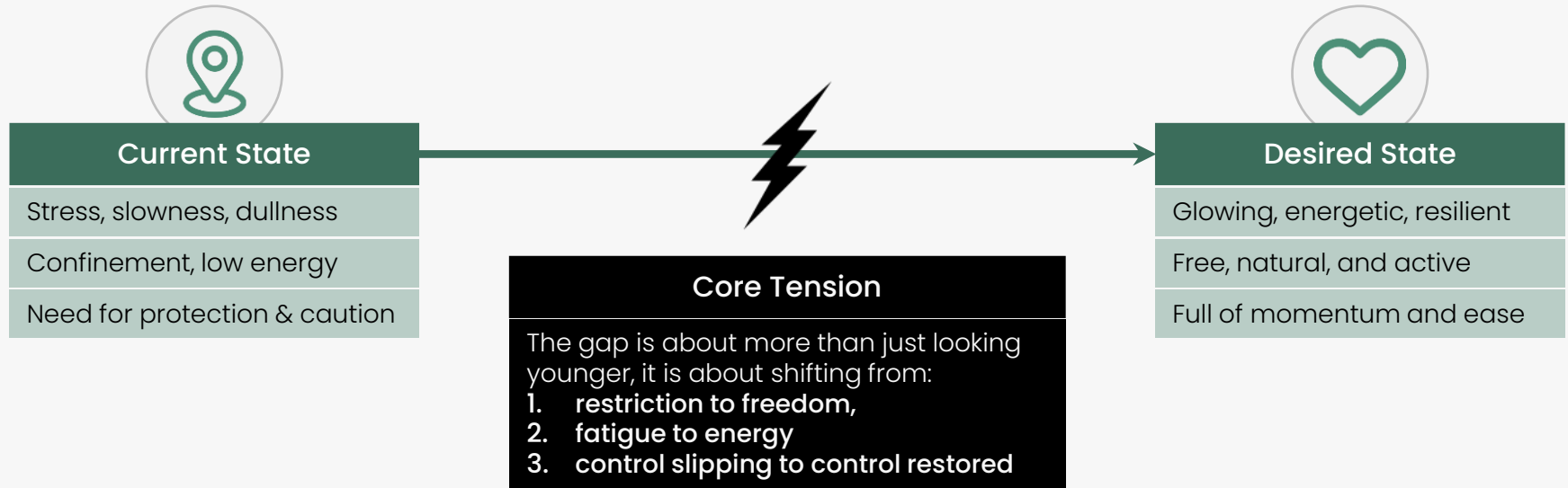


Internal
wellbeing



Appearance
benefit

Contrast between current self vs desired self images reveals deeper unmet needs beyond appearance



Daily Negotiation: Ageing is experienced as a constant balancing act between what males want to do and what their body now allows them to do.

1. **Desire vs Physical Limits:** Old habits and cravings remain, but the body reacts more negatively than before.
2. **Discipline vs Indulgence:** Food, sleep and activity require stricter control to avoid fatigue or discomfort.
3. **Good Days vs Bad Days:** Energy and mood become less predictable, making everyday functioning harder to manage



Good Day

- Strong energy levels
- Clear thinking and focus
- Stable mood and patience
- Pain-free body movement
- Ability to engage with family or hobbies



Bad Day

- Heavy fatigue and low stamina
- Brain fog and slow thinking
- Irritability or short temper
- Body stiffness or cramps
- Withdrawal from social interactions

Internal shifts that disrupt daily functioning (male verbatims)

RECOVERY COLLAPSE - *"If I do that continuously for six days, on the seventh day I am like collapsing and I don't have enough energy."*

— M/35-40/CHD

ENERGY CRASH - *"Post-lunch slump — या फिर शाम को ऐसा हो रहा होता है, बस 6-7 बजे के आसपास अब सो जाऊँ।"*

— M/35-40/CHD

PHYSICAL RESTRICTION *"When I cannot climb with the baggages... stress when I cannot sleep at night. Digestion is also an issue — if I go to a party and take some more food then it happens. I have to take a medicine at night."*

— M/46-50/KOL —

DIGESTIVE DISRUPTION - *"Just because if there is some outside food and that turns to food poisoning, my whole day gets very bad — going down to the washroom again and again unless that is looped out completely."*

— M/35-40/MUM — DIGESTIVE DISRUPTION

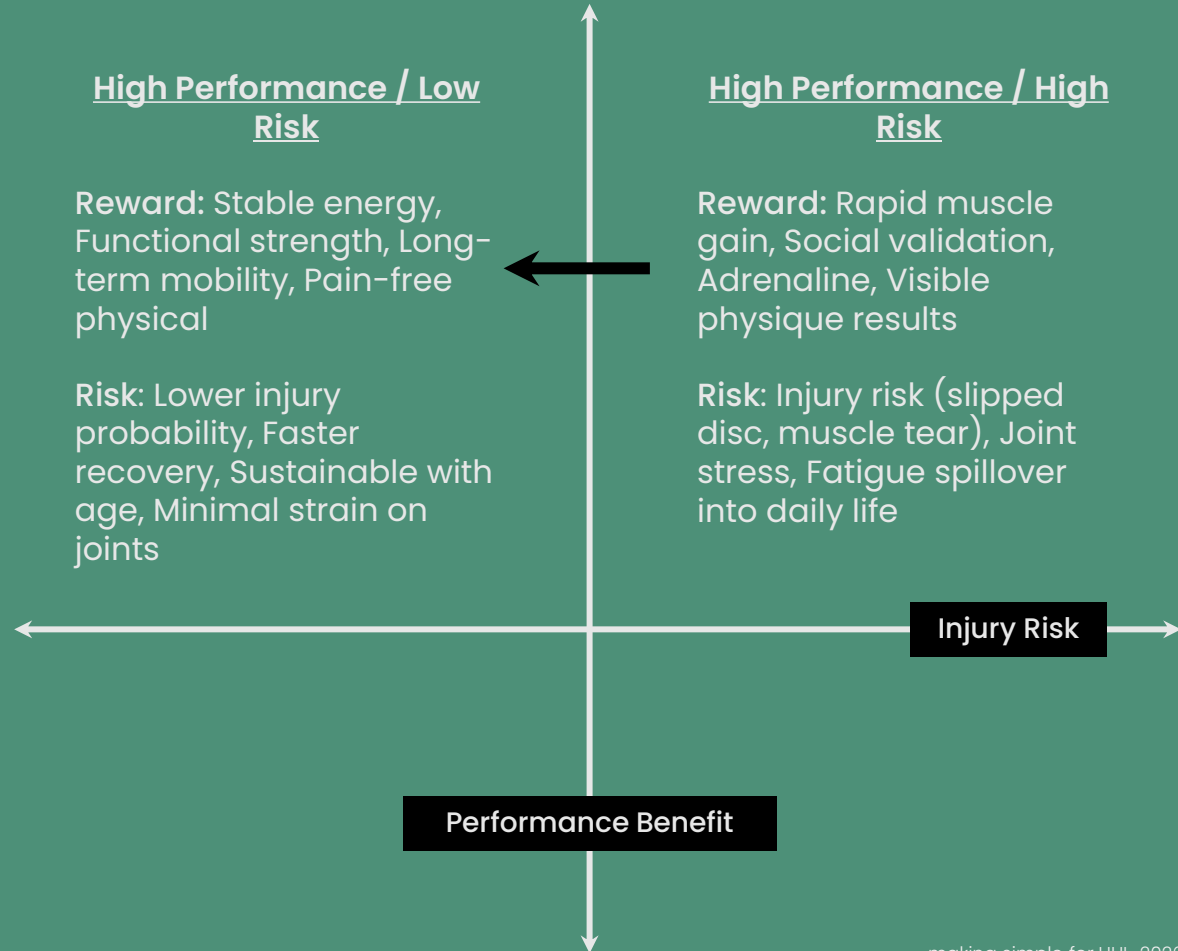
CONSTANT SELF-MONITORING - *"Today everything I want to do — even if I want to eat a chocolate — I would have to think, will this increase my diabetes? I have a little bit of oil, I have to be worried, will this increase my cholesterol?"*

— M/41-45/BLR

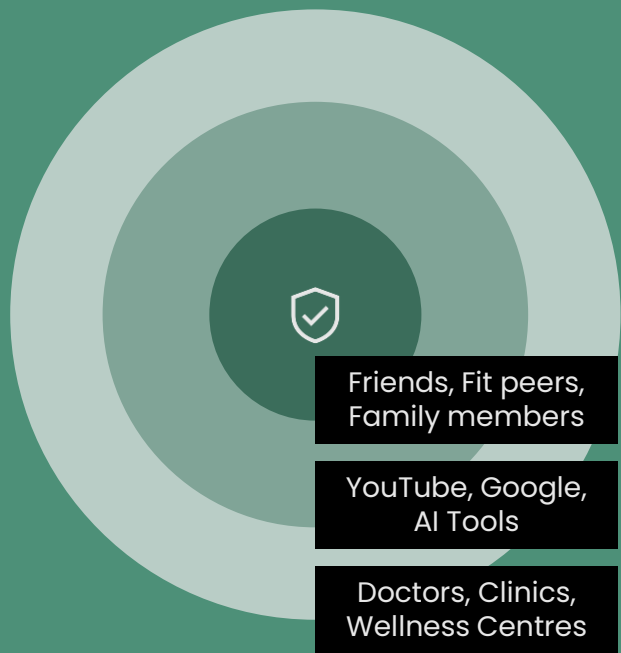
Performance to Preservation :

As ageing progresses, males stop pushing physical limits & instead focus on protecting their body for long-term stability.

1. **Dropping High-Impact Activities:** Intense sports, heavy gym routines and aggressive workouts begin to feel risky.
2. **Choosing Safer Movement:** Walking, yoga, stretching and swimming replace high-intensity training.
3. **Redefining Fitness:** Fitness shifts from building an impressive physique to maintaining mobility and avoiding injury.



Trust Shifts From Institutions to Peers: When it comes to health decisions, males rely more on personal research & peer experience than on doctors

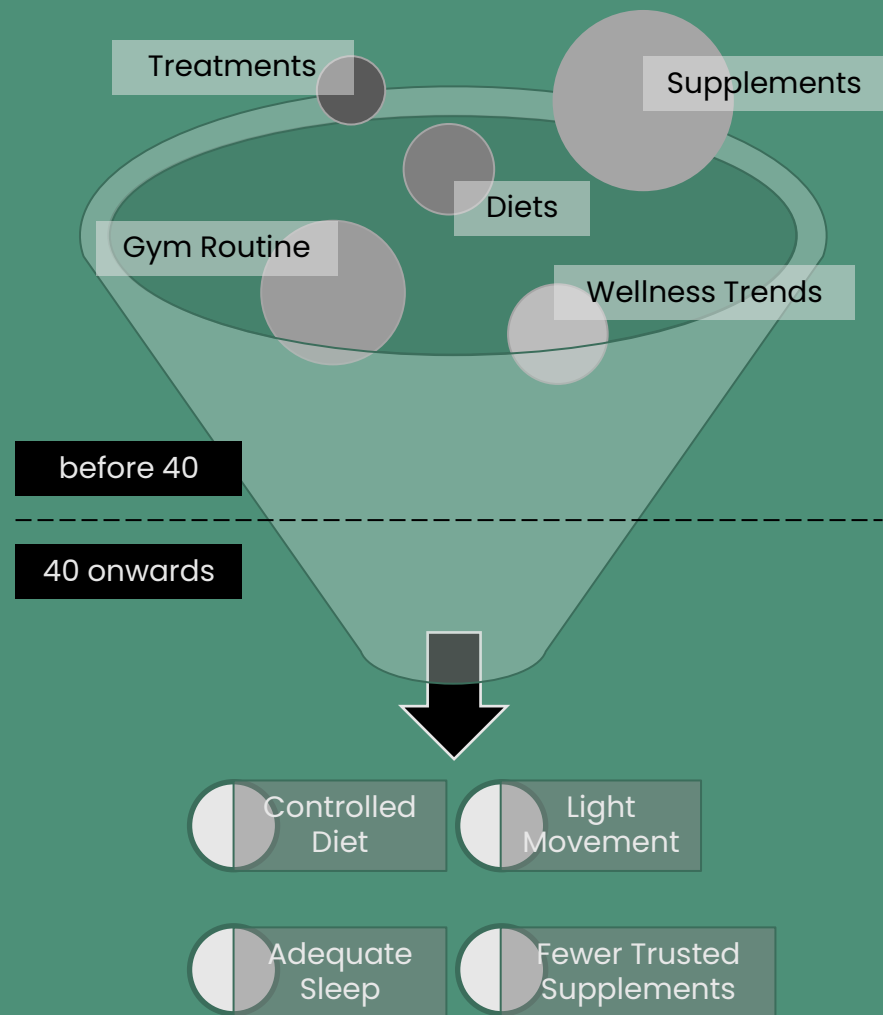


Trust Ecosystem Map

1. **Institutional Skepticism:** Doctors, clinics and expensive treatments are often viewed with suspicion or as commercially driven
2. **Self-Research Culture:** Crossing Health decisions are validated through Google, YouTube and personal investigation.
3. **Peer-Led Trust:** Advice from trusted friends, family members or visibly healthy peers carries the highest credibility.

Wellness Eventually Gets Simplified: After experimenting with many solutions, males reduce their routines to a few trusted habits that are easy to sustain

1. **Early Experimentation:** Initial attempts involve trying multiple supplements, treatments and routines.
2. **Wellness Fatigue:** Too many pills, complex routines and expensive interventions create confusion and drop-off.
3. **Simplified Routine:** Over time, males settle on a small set of repeatable habits that feel manageable and effective.



For males, retention is driven by ease, clarity, and control; drop-off happens when effort, risk, or complexity increases (1/2)



What Sticks (Sustained Behaviours)

- a. Low-effort, repeatable routines that fit daily life
- b. Solutions that show quick, tangible benefits
- c. Practices that feel safe, familiar, and within control

Daily supplements: protein (whey/plant), multivitamins, B12, C, D, Zinc, Magnesium, Omega-3

Targeted additions: collagen (e.g., MuscleBlaze) for joint and muscle recovery

Ayurvedic support: Ashwagandha, Safed Musli, Gokshura, Shatavari-based mixes

Diet control: portion regulation, cutting oily/junk food, lighter meals

Movement: walking, yoga, stretching, swimming

Behaviour	Brands / Products
Daily supplements	ProteinX, Kapiva Testofuel, Natural Tein Whey Protein, Omega-3, Zinc + Vitamin C + B12, Becadexamin, Maxine Magnesium
Joints and recovery	MuscleBlaze Collagen, Omega-3
Ayurvedic support	Ashwagandha + Safed Musli + Gokshura + Shatavari (custom mix), Shilajit, Amla + Chyawanprash
Hair and grooming	L'Oreal Inoa, Bajaj Almond Drops, Himalaya

For males, retention is driven by ease, clarity, and control; drop-off happens when effort, risk, or complexity increases (2/2)



What Drops (Abandoned / Avoided Behaviours)

- High-effort, recovery-heavy or time-intensive routines
- Solutions with unclear benefits or delayed outcomes
- Interventions perceived as risky, artificial, or over-medicalised

Heavy gymming / intense sports: leads to fatigue, injury risk, long recovery

Complex multi-step routines: hard to sustain daily

Cosmetic / salon-led treatments: seen as low functional value

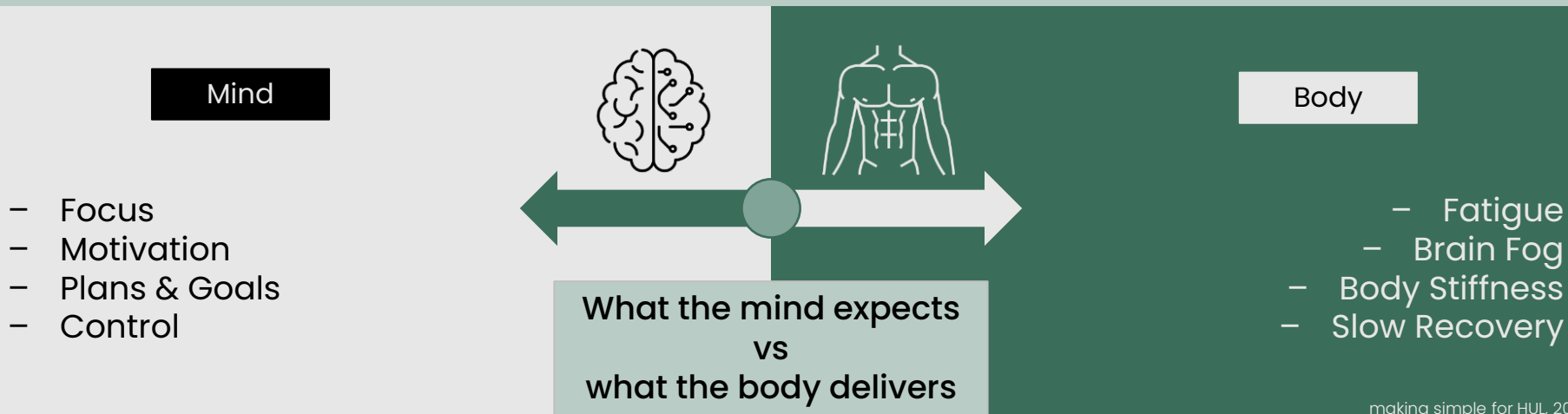
Clinical / “chemical” interventions: IV drips, medicated facials, aggressive treatments

Overuse of supplements: too many pills leading to confusion or fatigue

Behaviour	Brands / Products
Supplements abandoned	MuscleBlaze protein powder, OZiva, Olena, HealthKart Collagen, ZMA, Shilajit, Ashwagandha
Sports and gym abandoned	Cricket, heavy lifting, gym
Clinical interventions rejected	Vitamin D3 injections, IV drips, hair clinic treatments
Sexual wellness products avoided	Delay sprays

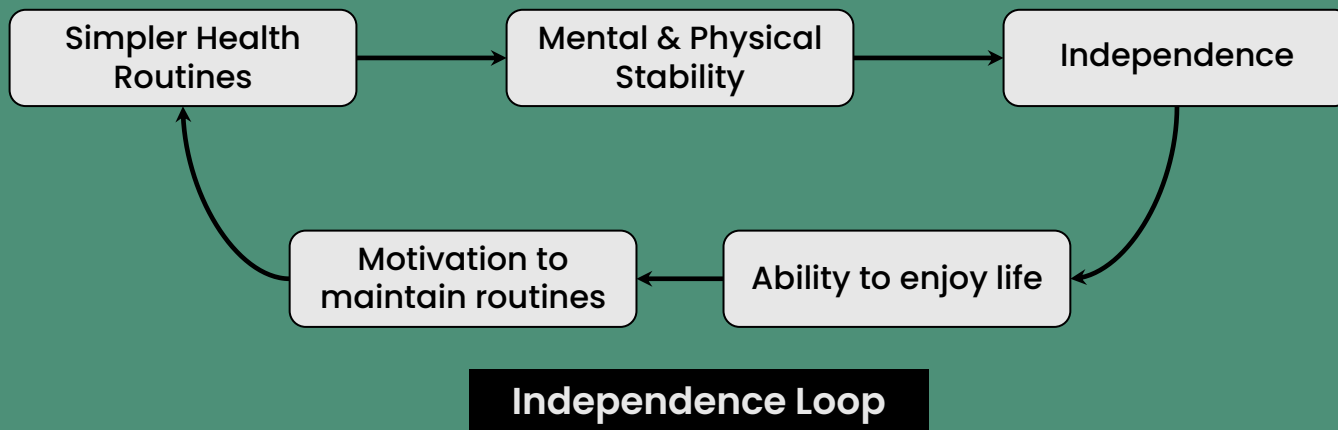
Ageing Feels Like Losing Control: As the body becomes less predictable, ageing is experienced as a loss of control over energy, mood and everyday functioning

1. **Unpredictable Energy:** Energy levels fluctuate sharply, making some days productive while others feel physically draining.
2. **Mind–Body Disconnect:** The mind wants to function normally, but fatigue, brain fog or physical discomfort slow the body down.
3. **Emotional Spillover:** Poor sleep, fatigue and physical discomfort often lead to irritability, frustration or withdrawal.



Longevity Is About Restoring Control: Longevity is ultimately pursued as a way to regain control over the body, daily life and future independence

1. **Control Over the Body:** Maintaining strength, mobility and energy to keep the body dependable.
2. **Control Over Daily Life:** Health routines are built to ensure consistent functioning at work, home and socially.
3. **Control Over the Future:** Longevity is linked to staying independent long enough to enjoy life after years of responsibility.





Bounce-Back Accelerators

JTBD: Help my system rapidly reset after strain or minor indulgence so I don't lose tomorrow to fatigue

"I used to eat anything and recover instantly. Now one bad meal ruins my whole week."

Men feel ageing first not in the mirror but in how long it takes to bounce back. One bad night, one heavy meal, one late evening now costs them the next day.

OZiva / Product

Gap: Nothing in OZiva's current men's range speaks specifically to recovery from everyday strain — bad food, alcohol, late nights. The positioning is still skewed toward performance and muscle

Launch: An OZiva Men's Recovery Stack — Ashwagandha, Magnesium, and a gut-friendly protein — positioned around getting tomorrow back, not building today's body

Comms: The brief is simple. "So yesterday doesn't ruin today." Functional, male, no gym required

Olly / Daily Energy

Fit: Olly's Daily Energy gummy maps directly onto this need for men who are not supplement users yet and would never pick up a protein tub

Reframe: In India, do not position it around performance. Position it around recovery. "So yesterday doesn't cost you tomorrow" works as well for Olly as it does for Oziva

Entry: This is one of two genuine Olly plays in the male segment. The format removes the chemical anxiety that kills supplement trial in this cohort

JTBD: Keep my system light and stable so I can stay energetic, focused, and in control



Metabolic Balance Systems

Dr. Abhishek switched protein brands entirely because standard whey was bloating him. Lokesh says his digestion power has dropped significantly compared to ten years ago. Kaushik deals with constipation daily. The pattern is consistent: men are not ignoring this problem, they are self-solving it inefficiently through dietary restriction and brand switching.

OZiva / Product

Opportunity: Men are already looking for a cleaner protein that does not bloat. OZiva's plant based protein is the direct answer but most men in this cohort do not know it exists or that it would solve this specific problem

Comms: Do not lead with "plant based." Lead with "easier on your stomach than whey." That is the actual brief this consumer is searching for

Gut support: Bundle a digestive enzyme or probiotic alongside the protein as a system. Men are already reaching for antacids and home remedies after meals. A proactive gut support product positioned as daily maintenance, not a fix, would fit naturally into their existing self-management behaviour

Oly

Oly does not fit here. Gut health and metabolic support require ingredient credibility that Oly has not established. Pushing Oly into this space before it has built trust in India would work against the brand.



Night Decompressors

JTBD: Help me switch off, recover, and wake up ready for the next day

"Stress comes to my mind when I cannot sleep. One or two hours it disturbs my sleep, some tension or stress."

Men know exactly why they cannot sleep. The problem is not the sleep itself; it is the inability to switch off after a high-pressure day. And the solutions available feel worse than the problem — addictive, chemical, stomach-ruining.

OZiva / Product

Gap: OZiva has a Magnesium Melatonin product but it is marketed as a sleep supplement. That framing triggers exactly the chemical anxiety and addiction fear that makes men avoid sleep solutions

Reframe: Relaunch it as a recovery product, not a sleep product. "Your body did a lot today. Let it fix itself tonight." The product does not change. The story does

Format: Keep it as a capsule for OZiva. The existing user base trusts this format. The reframe does the work, not a format change

Olly / Sleep Gummy

Fit: This is Olly's strongest single play in the male segment. The gummy format directly addresses the addiction and chemical fear that makes men avoid clinical sleep solutions

Positioning: "Natural, non-habit forming, works while you sleep." Simple. No ingredient education needed

Entry: Lead India launch for the male segment with Sleep. Not Goodbye Stress, not Daily Energy. Sleep is where Olly's format advantage is most differentiated from what already exists in market

JTBD: Protect my joints, bones, and structural integrity so I can stay mobile and independent



Structural Preservation

Moin is constantly stressed about making the wrong physical move, fearing a slipped disc will leave him permanently disabled. Kaushik can no longer carry grocery bags from the fish market and climb stairs alone. Dr. Abhishek started taking collagen only after a severe hamstring tear forced his hand. Men are not being proactive here. They are reacting to damage that has already started.

OZiva / Product

Gap: Men are already self-assembling Omega 3, Collagen, Vitamin D3, and Magnesium from different sources. The same self-assembly problem we saw with women on hormonal health exists here for men on structural health

Bundle: Launch an OZiva Men's Joint and Bone stack combining Collagen, Omega 3, and Vitamin D3 as one purchase. Position it around staying on your feet, not athletic performance. "So you can carry your own groceries at 60" is more resonant than any gym-coded message

Channel: Peer led seeding is the only trust pathway that works here. Men adopt supplements only after seeing a trusted peer use it successfully. Seed this through older, visibly fit men in their social circles, not fitness influencers

Olly

Olly does not fit here. Joint and bone health requires ingredient credibility and clinical trust signals. Olly has neither in India yet.



Safe-Science Daily Stacks

JTBD: Give me a simple, trusted daily system that works without risk or confusion

Sunny avoided supplements entirely after watching a friend's face break out in severe pimples from a muscle building powder. Men in this study do not distrust wellness. They distrust anything that feels synthetic, overcomplicated, or commercially motivated. Their decision-making pathway is consistent: see a trusted peer use it, research it on Google and YouTube, cross check with a pharmacist, then and only then consider trying it.

OZiva / Product

Positioning: OZiva's science plus Ayurveda hybrid is the only supplement brand positioning in India that passes the "not a chemical" test while still being credible on efficacy. This is not a product gap, it is an underutilised positioning asset

Comms: Stop leading with ingredients and certifications. Lead with peer stories. Real men, real results, specific and unglamorous. "My colleague told me about this. I checked the label. Three months later my energy is different." That is the trust pathway this man actually uses

Simplicity: Any OZiva men's daily stack recommendation must be three products or fewer. More than that triggers the wellness fatigue and overconsumption anxiety that causes abandonment

Olly / Daily Energy

Fit: Olly's benefit first naming removes the ingredient anxiety entirely. "Goodbye Stress" and "Sleep" require no label reading, no YouTube research, no pharmacist visit

Sequence: Position Olly as where men who are not yet supplement users start. Low commitment, low anxiety, low effort. OZiva is where they graduate to for something more structured

Limit: This is Olly's second and final genuine play in the male segment. Do not stretch it further

JTBD: Help me stay capable, energetic, and free to live life on my own terms

"I need to retire by 55. If I wait until 65, I won't have the energy to climb a hill."

Men in this study are not afraid of ageing. They are afraid of running out of physical capability before they run out of time. The bucket list is real and specific. Skydiving. Mount Everest. Carrying their own bags. The fear is not death. It is dependence.

OZiva / Product

Gap: No supplement brand in India is speaking to men about the reward phase of life. Every men's wellness campaign is about performance today, not freedom tomorrow

Campaign: "You have worked hard for 25 years. Make sure your body is ready for what comes next." Target the 45 to 50 cohort specifically. Not gym goers. Men who are starting to think about what the second half looks like

Product hook: The campaign does not need a new product. It needs a new frame for existing products. Ashwagandha, Magnesium, Omega 3, joint support. Positioned not as maintenance but as preparation for the life they have been putting off

Olly

Olly does not fit here. This white space requires a long-term brand narrative built around life stage aspiration. Olly is not established enough in India to carry that story yet. This is OZiva's territory alone.



Second Life Enablers

that's all folks!

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Person
This is a
description
of the
image on
the left of
the slide
described

Plane Filling II,
by M.C. Escher, in 1957



APPENDIX

ABOUT THIS RESEARCH STUDY

Research objectives:

- 1. How do consumers think about ageing beyond surface-level beauty?
- 2. Decode the journey from early awareness to active management of perimenopause and menopause (symptoms, challenges & solutions)
- 3. Map how consumers interpret symptoms, triggers, and internal changes across life stages
- 4. Explore evolving behaviours, routines, and supplement usage where they are ready to invest?
- 5. Identify unmet needs, gaps, support needed and opportunities for HUL

Research method: N= 27

		Metro	Mini metro	Total
Women	36-40 years	5	2	7
	41- 45 years	5	2	7
	46-50 years	5	2	7
Men	36-42 years	2	1	3
	43-50 years	2	1	3

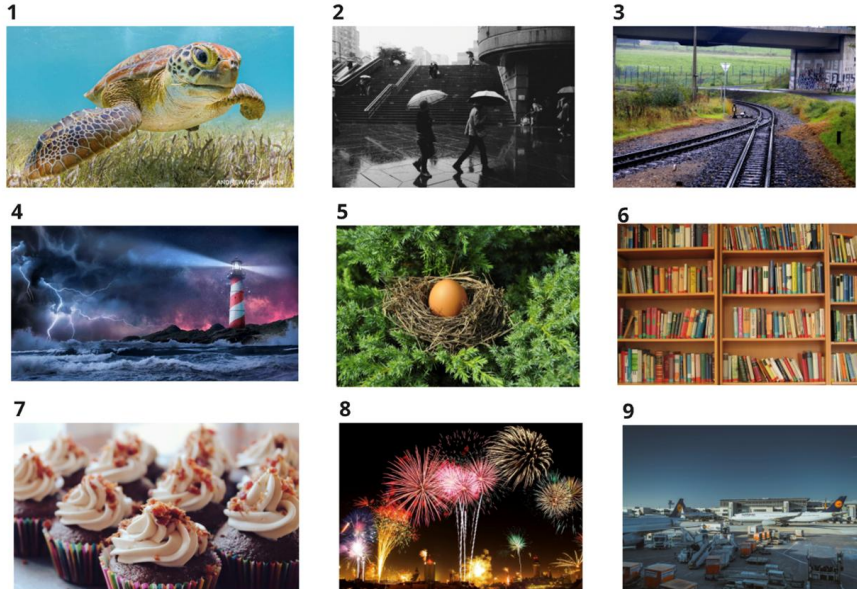
Metro cities:
Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Kolkata

Mini metro cities:
Goa, Chandigarh, Mysuru

"How I see myself" projective technique: Ask the respondent to:

1. Pick one image that best reflects how you see yourself today when you look in the mirror
2. Pick one image that reflects how you wish to look today when you look in the mirror

1A



Most Chosen by Females

Current self – 6 (Library/Books) and 7 (Cupcakes)

Desired self – Image 8 (Fireworks) – overwhelming majority

"Everything is bright and shine and look so beautiful colorful – I want to be ki like matlab main bhi aise colorful ya presentive dikhna chahti hoon." – Neha

"इट्स वै लाइटनिंग एंड हैप्पीनेस... I want to see my screen like wow." – Sheetal

Most Chosen by Males

Current self – 1 (Turtle) and 6 (Library/Books)

Desired self – Image 7 (Cupcakes)

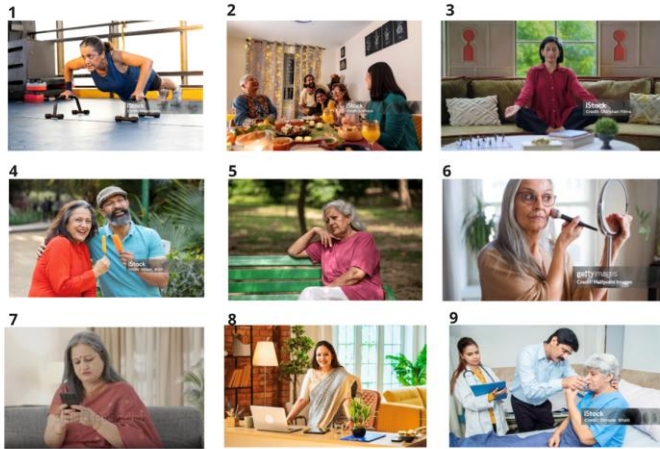
"मैं ऐसा बनना चाहूंगा कि चॉकलेटी एंड ग्लोइंग एंड सिल्की – वो वाली फीलिंग" – Sunny

"I want to be the chocolate which gets positive thoughts to everybody's mind." – Mohammed Moin

“Future self” projective technique: Ask the respondent:

1. Which of these feels closest to how you would like to be in the future? Why?
2. Which of these feels far from how you would want to be? What makes you not want this?

1BW- future self



Most desired — 4 (Carefree couple) and 2 (Social group)
Most avoided — 9 (Hospital) and 5 (Lonely/troubled woman)

"Both are very happy and enjoying that moment. There is no depression. There is no worry about anything." — Payal
"I find that very lonely. There's something about that picture that feels sad." — Teena

1BM- future self



Most desired — 8 (Couple laughing/piggyback) and 3 (Active/cycling)
Most avoided — 4 (Wheelchair/hospital)

"The man carrying his wife on his back and they are both laughing and enjoying... we are going to travel the world." — Dr. Abhishek

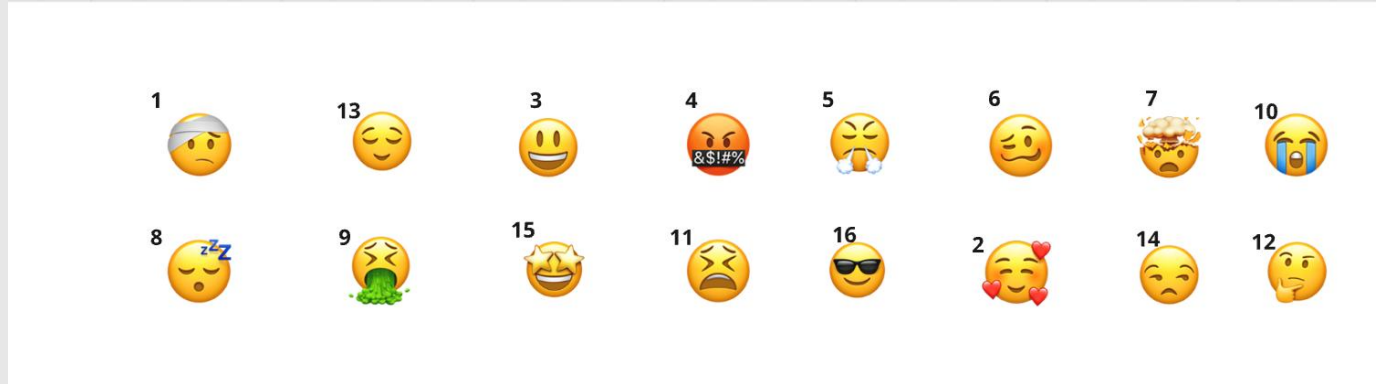
“Good, bad and ugly days” projective technique:

“Think of a really good day you may have had off-late (in relation to mind and body wellness). I would like you to...:

1. Pick emojis that best describe how a good day feels. Why so?

“Think of a really bad day you may have had off-late. I would like you to...”

1. Pick emojis that best describe how a bad/low day feels. Why so?



Female Choices

Good day: Emoji 2 (Smiling with hearts)

Bad day: Emoji 10 (Crying), Emoji 11 (Screaming), Emoji 4 (Angry)

Male Choices

Good day: Emoji 2 (Smiling with hearts) and Emoji 3 (Big smile)

Bad day: Emoji 14 (Sad/down), Emoji 6 (Confused), Emoji 4 (Angry)